

INDABAX SOUTH SUDAN 2026 · SCENIUS HUB, JUBA

START NOW:

Building AI and ML Skills as a
Student

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MY JOURNEY SO FAR

From studying software engineering in to building AI models

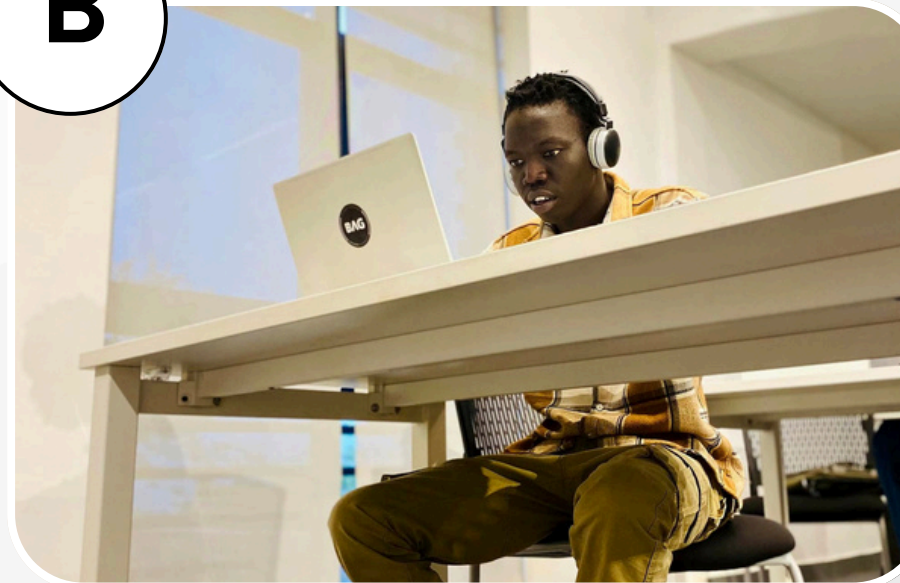
A



• STUDY

MCF Scholar at ALU, Kigali, graduate of Software Engineering. My interest in data began when I first cleaned a messy students attendance dataset / built a dashboard in Power BI

B



• BUILD

I learned by building: hackathons, School projects and networking.

C



• TODAY

Technical Project Lead at Businesslab IT Services. AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate.

WHERE TO START: FIVE STEPS, IN ORDER

AI/ML Roadmap

- 1 FUNDAMENTALS
- 2 MATH FOR AI/ML
- 3 MACHINE LEARNING BASICS
- 4 DEEP LEARNING
- 5 REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS & PROJECTS

01

Programming (Python)

Write small programs,
every day

02

Data handling

pandas, cleaning messy
data, basic SQL

03

Maths and statistics

Learn just in time, as
models demand it

04

Machine learning fundamentals

scikit-learn: train, test,
evaluate

05

Deep learning

Only once the basics are
solid

LEARNING BY BUILDING:

Pick a problem you can see, not a famous dataset. Our team chose one: health information that people who don't speak English cannot easily use.



- **The problem**

Medical information is hard to access for people who don't speak English, especially in rural communities.

- **The build**

Unesis AI: NLP pipelines that translate medical information into local African languages. Team of 4, built in 48 hours.

- **The result**

1st Place at the ALU × Meta Hackathon 2024, for social impact and technical innovation.

FREE TOOLS AND COURSES

- Machine Learning Specialization (Andrew Ng): Coursera, free audit option
- Google Machine Learning Crash Course: free, with interactive exercises
- Kaggle Intro to ML: short lessons on real data
- FreeCodeCamp, Machine Learning with Python: full video course
- DataCamp Machine Learning Scientist Track
- DataCamp Machine Learning Engineer

Kaggle Learn for short hands-on lessons. **Google Colab** for free notebooks with no strong laptop.



SHOW YOUR WORK. THEN START.

Pick one problem. Build one project. Start this month.



01

Portfolio

- GitHub with 2–3 finished projects
- A simple personal site

02

Communities

- Zindi competitions
- AWS Cloud Club(AWS SBG)
- Kaggle

03

Pathways

- Scholarships
- Internships
- Research placements

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THANK YOU

Questions welcome.

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